

## **CLAUSE**

A clause is a group of words that has subject, predicate and a finite verb. A finite verb is a verb that can change by person, number or tense. Example:

Sam is my friend

Sam and Susan are my friends.

Sam was my friend

Note, the verb 'is' changed to 'are' in the second sentence when the number of persons increased and changed to 'was' in the third when the tense was changed. A subject is the person or the thing being talked about; it could be a word or a group of words. Example:

Adekunle is my classmate

Our noisy neighbours are generous

'Adekunle' and 'our noisy neighbours' are the subjects of these sentences while 'is my classmate' and 'are generous' are the predicates. The predicate is the part which talks about the subject in the sentence.

## **TYPES OF CLAUSES**

There are **two types of clauses**:

**independent /main clause**

**dependent/subordinate clause**

Independent/main clause is a clause that can stand on its own to convey meaning while a dependent/subordinate clause is a clause that depends on main clause to convey meaning.

## **CHARACTERISTICS OF A MAIN CLAUSE**

It contains a subject and a finite verb

It can stand alone

It conveys a full meaning

Example: she cooked the food happily.

The trophy belongs to the champion.

My father is a businessman.

Ada could not talk.

## **CHARACTERISTICS OF DEPENDENT CLAUSE**

It consists of a subject and a finite verb.

It cannot stand alone.

It is often introduced by subordinating conjunctions like: because, while, whose, that, before, how, which, who, whom etc. example:

Because he came late

Which you mentioned yesterday

That you gave me

Which was opened yesterday

### **KINDS OF SUBORDINATE CLAUSE**

Noun clause

Adjectival clause

Adverbial clause